A SHIPPER'S RESOURCE

Automotive, Heavy Equipment and Special-Purpose Vehicles Import Readiness Checklist

12 things to confirm before you book your next shipment, so the permits, customs treatment and delivery plan are settled early.

Why Late Compliance Costs You in Automotive

For automotive, heavy equipment and special-purpose vehicles cargo, the cost is rarely the freight. It is a permit, classification or handling requirement discovered after the goods have already shipped. Typical cargo includes passenger and commercial vehicles, trucks, buses, forklifts, cranes, earthmoving equipment, ambulances and specialized mobile units. Mills Permits, Mills Customs and Mills Logistics work together to settle these points before you book.

Use this list before you book. Any box you cannot tick is the item to resolve first.

The Readiness Checklist

- ☐ **1. The vehicle or equipment type is defined**
  Record the make, model, year, condition and intended use, since eligibility and taxes depend on them.

- ☐ **2. Import eligibility is checked**
  Confirm whether the unit can be imported, especially if used, and whether pre-import approval such as FTEB applies.

- ☐ **3. Importer accreditation is confirmed**
  Check that the importer holds any accreditation required to bring in this type of vehicle or equipment.

- ☐ **4. BIR and excise treatment is checked**
  Confirm whether an ATRIG applies and how excise tax is expected to be treated for the unit.

- ☐ **5. Valuation documents are gathered**
  Collect the invoice, payment records and any inspection reports that support the declared value.

- ☐ **6. Tariff classification is agreed**
  Agree on the classification for each unit and its parts, and keep it consistent across all documents.

- ☐ **7. Emissions and technical requirements are reviewed**
  Confirm whether emissions or technical standards apply to the unit, and what proof is needed.

- ☐ **8. Equipment-specific permits are mapped**
  For cranes, ambulances and other specialized units, identify any permit tied to their use.

- ☐ **9. The shipping method is chosen**
  Decide between RoRo, container or breakbulk, based on size, condition and port handling.

The Readiness Checklist (continued)

- [ ] **10. Port release and inspection are planned**
  Plan for customs examination and any physical inspection, and who will attend.

- [ ] **11. LTO registration steps are known**
  Know what is needed from the LTO after release and before the unit can be used on the road.

- [ ] **12. Delivery of large units is arranged**
  Arrange trucking, escorts and route checks for units that exceed standard road limits.

Moving automotive cargo?
Let us check it before it ships.

Book a short call and we will review your product, permits and delivery plan before it moves.

BOOK A CALL

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General guidance only, not legal advice. Requirements vary by product and shipment; confirm with The Mills before booking.